FindIt — README

Project overview, features, setup, and execution

1. Project Overview

FindIt is a web-based Lost and Found application developed using Java and Spring Boot. It is intended to provide a simple interface for reporting and viewing information about lost and found items. Confirm that the described features match the current implementation before submission.

2. Technologies

Java; Spring Boot; Spring MVC; Thymeleaf; Spring Data JPA; Hibernate; Maven; HTML/CSS; and MySQL if configured in the project.

3. Features

- Dashboard for item information
- Lost and found item reporting
- Display of reported items
- Form validation
- Database integration

4. Installation and Execution

Prerequisites: a compatible JDK, Maven or the Maven Wrapper, and the configured database software if required.

1. Clone the repository and open the project folder.
2. Configure database settings in `src/main/resources/application.properties`.
3. Open the project in an IDE or terminal.
4. Run `mvn spring-boot:run` or run `FinditApplication.java`.
5. When startup succeeds, open `http://localhost:8080` in a browser.

5. Configuration Notes

Do not commit real passwords, API keys, or other secrets to GitHub. The database name, dependencies, and required configuration must match the actual project.

6. Purpose

This project demonstrates a Java web application using Spring Boot, MVC request handling, Thymeleaf templates, and database persistence.